Social Media Marketing

BA 3205 — Digital Marketing | Bangladesh + Global Examples

What is Social Media Marketing?

In simple words: Using platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok to promote your brand, talk to customers, and sell — instead of just running TV or newspaper ads.

Think of it like this:

A bakery in Dhaka posts a photo of a fresh cake on Facebook. Someone likes it, comments 'looks yummy', and messages to order.

That whole chain — posting, engaging, and selling — is social media marketing.

Why It Matters: The Numbers

Stat	What It Means
5.2+ billion	People use social media worldwide — nearly 64% of everyone on Earth
64 million	Facebook users in Bangladesh alone — the country's biggest online audience
95%	Of people aged 18-34 follow at least one brand on social media
4.2x ROAS (return on ad spend)	Average return businesses get from Meta (Facebook + Instagram) ads

Your customers are already there. The question isn't 'should I use social media' — it's 'am I using it well?'

Key Platforms & What They're Best For

Platform	Best For	Bangladesh Note
Facebook	Broad reach, community groups, local ads	Biggest platform in BD — 64M+ users
Instagram	Visual products — fashion, food, beauty	Popular with younger urban shoppers
TikTok	Short viral videos, younger audience	Growing fast, great for challenger brands
YouTube	Long videos, tutorials, storytelling	Good for reviews and how-to content
LinkedIn	B2B, professional networking, hiring	Used by BD businesses and job seekers

Organic vs Paid Social Media

Aspect	Organic (Free)	Paid (Ads)
Cost	Free — just time and effort	You pay per click or per view
Reach	Only your followers, often limited by algorithm	Reach anyone you target, even non-followers
Speed	Slow to grow	Fast results, scalable overnight
Best For	Building trust, community, long-term brand	Sales, launches, urgent promotions
Example	Daily Instagram posts and Stories	A Facebook ad targeted to 'women, 20-30, Dhaka'

Building a Content Strategy

Know your audience — age, location, interests (who are you talking to?)

Pick the right platforms — don't try to be everywhere at once

Plan a content calendar — decide what to post and when, in advance

Mix content types — photos, Reels, Stories, polls, live videos

Balance your message — don't only sell; educate and entertain too

Content Mix: The 50/30/20 Rule

A simple rule to balance what you post, so your page doesn't feel like an ad billboard:

50%

Value

Tips, how-tos, entertaining posts — builds trust

30%

Brand

Behind-the-scenes, team, story — builds authority

20%

Promo

Offers, discounts, CTAs — drives the sale

Example: A Dhaka clothing page's 10 monthly posts = 5 styling tips + 3 behind-the-scenes + 2 sale posts

Types of Content You Can Post

Content Type	Simple Example
Photos	Product shots, team pictures
Reels / Short Videos	Quick how-to, trending sounds, product demo
Stories	Polls, countdowns, behind-the-scenes moments
Live Video	Q&A session, live product launch
User-Generated Content	Reposting a happy customer's photo/review
Carousel Posts	Multiple images in one post — before/after, steps

How to Measure Success: Key Metrics

Metric	In Simple Words
Reach	How many different people saw your post
Impressions	How many times your post appeared (can count the same person twice)
Engagement Rate	% of followers who liked, commented, or shared
Followers Growth	How fast your audience is growing
Click-Through Rate (CTR)	% of people who clicked your link or 'Shop Now' button
Conversion Rate	% of clicks that turned into an actual sale or sign-up

Case Study — Bangladesh: Khaas Food

Khaas Food is a Bangladeshi e-commerce brand selling fresh, organic food online

Ran a two-phase Facebook ad campaign: first targeting existing customers, then new lookalike audiences

Used photo and carousel ads showing best-selling products

Installed Facebook Pixel to track website visitors and build custom + lookalike audiences

Featured as an official Facebook Business success story

Results (6 months): +45% sales, +40% new customers, +42% better return on ad spend

Case Study — Global: Wendy's

A mid-sized U.S. fast-food chain with a far smaller budget than McDonald's or Burger King

Built a witty, sassy brand voice on Twitter (now X) instead of a typical corporate tone

Ran the 'Roast Me' campaign — asked followers to be roasted, replied with witty jabs

The 2017 'Nuggs for Carter' tweet passed 3.4 million retweets — once the most-retweeted tweet ever

Twitter following grew from under 1 million to over 3.7 million between 2017-2020

Lesson: A distinctive, consistent brand voice + real engagement can beat a bigger budget.

Best Practices & Common Mistakes

✅ Do This	❌ Avoid This
Post consistently, even if just 3x/week	Posting once, then disappearing for a month
Reply to comments and DMs quickly	Ignoring customer questions or complaints
Use real photos and simple captions	Overusing stock photos and buzzwords
Track what works and repeat it	Posting randomly with no plan
Mix content — value, brand, promo	Only posting sales and discounts

Key Takeaways

#	Key Point
1	Social media marketing = promoting and selling through platforms customers already use
2	Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, and LinkedIn each serve a different purpose
3	Organic builds trust slowly; paid ads deliver fast, targeted reach
4	The 50/30/20 rule keeps your content balanced — not just sales posts
5	Track reach, engagement rate, CTR, and conversions to know what's working
6	Real brands — Khaas Food, Wendy's — prove strategy beats budget size

Discussion & Assignment

Quick Discussion: Pick a brand's Facebook or Instagram page. Is their content mostly sales posts, or a healthy mix?

Assignment: Plan a Mini Social Media Calendar

- Pick a business idea (real or imaginary)
- Plan 10 posts for one month using the 50/30/20 rule

Thank You! Questions?

Next Class: Mobile Marketing